

May 2007. In this same time span, many regulators began to believe that the U.S. housing market was overextended and likely in for a rough ride.²² It's hard to believe someone with such breadth of knowledge as Satoshi would be working in isolation from what he was witnessing in global financial markets.

The day after publishing his white paper, Satoshi sent an email to "The Cryptography Mailing List" with a link to his paper.²³ The list was composed of subscribers focused on cryptography and its potential applications. Satoshi's email sparked a chain of responses.

On Friday, November 7, 2008, in reply to his increasingly passionate group of followers, he wrote: "You will not find a solution to political problems in cryptography ... but we can win a major battle in the arms race and gain a new territory of freedom for several years. Governments are good at cutting off the heads of centrally controlled networks like Napster, but pure P2P networks like Gnutella and Tor seem to be holding their own."²⁴ It's clear from this quote that Satoshi was not creating Bitcoin to slip seamlessly into the existing governmental and financial system, but instead to be an alternative system free of top-down control, governed by the decentralized masses. Such decentralized autonomy was foundational to the early days of the Internet as well, where each node on the network was an autonomous agent that corresponded with other agents through shared protocols.

On November 9, the Bitcoin project was registered on SourceForge.net, a website geared toward facilitating open-